



The illustrations on these pages show six varieties of iris

COLORING IN

Illustrations such as these beautiful flowers from John Gerard's *History of Plants* of 1597 were sometimes included in printed books. The 1,800 pictures in this book were printed in black and white from carved blocks of wood, and color was added by hand. The slow hand-coloring process made this an extremely expensive book.

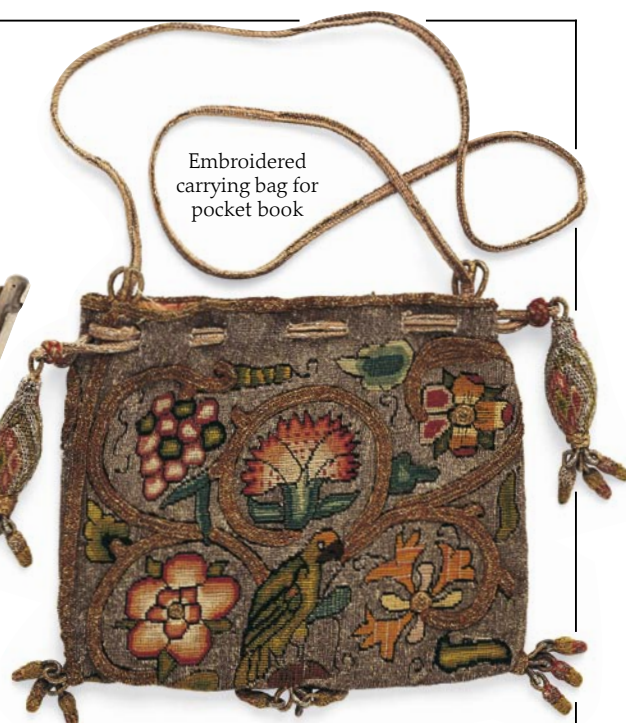


Pressmen usually worked in pairs

Bar to lower platen

Detail from a 17th-century engraving of a print shop

Tympan



Embroidered carrying bag for pocket book

BOOK IN A BAG

It was fashionable in Shakespeare's day to read while walking in the open air, and pretty, pocket-sized books were ideal for this. Pocket books often contained short religious texts, to appeal to Puritans, or almanacs, which were predictions of the coming year's events.



16th-century pocket book, with a gallant in a feathered hat for decoration

This book was designed to be kept on a shelf in a row with identically bound editions of other Shakespeare plays



Sliding coffin

Leather ink ball, stuffed with horsehair

Shakespeare's coat of arms



UNLIMITED EDITIONS

By 1913, when this copy of *Romeo and Juliet* was printed, hundreds of editions of Shakespeare's plays had been published. This expensive volume, with its embossed leather cover, was designed to look impressive in the library of an upper-class house. Cheaper editions were also being read around the world by an audience far larger than Shakespeare ever could have imagined possible.